

SCAFFOLD

SUPPORTS TERTIARY WHY

FOR WHAT-HOW · HOW-WHAT

The So-What Translator

A template that converts detailed output into audience meaning. **For every section, one completed sentence:** "which means that..." The reader gets significance without you having to feel it first.

THE DRAIN

WHAT-HOW and HOW-WHAT profiles produce work rich in accurate content and light on stated significance, because deriving what it means to the audience is purpose work, and it drains. The audience, especially executives, reads thoroughness without meaning as noise, and the work gets undervalued.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The translator is a mechanical move that manufactures meaning from content you already have. Each major section of a deliverable gets one forced completion, "which means that, for this reader...", and the strongest completion gets promoted to the front. The output reads as strategic; the process was procedural.

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 Name the specific reader first.** "Which means that" has no answer without a who. A title and a current worry.
- 2 Complete every section, no exceptions.** The discipline is the tool. Skipped sections are where meaning was needed most.
- 3 Lead with meaning, follow with detail.** Your instinct orders it the other way. For mixed audiences, invert it.
- 4 Keep the appendix.** The full detail survives, one layer down, for the readers wired to want it.

The translation move

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|-------------------------------|--|
| 1 List the sections | Every major finding, feature, or component of the deliverable. |
| 2 Force the completion | For each: "...which means that, for this audience," finished honestly in one line. |
| 3 Rank the completions | Which one changes a decision the reader actually faces? |
| 4 Promote the winner | It becomes the opening line or executive summary. Detail follows as support. |
| 5 Cut the orphans | A section with no honest completion may not belong in this version. |

WHAT IT WON'T DO

The translator produces stated significance, not strategy; it cannot tell you whether the work matters, only say clearly what it means if it does. And for HOW-primary audiences, ease off, they trust detail-first ordering, and over-translated content reads to them as thin.

IN THE KIT

Translator worksheet

Reader profile card

Before/after example

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 28 Narrative Arc Template · **Tool 29** The Opening Line Habit · **Tool 40** Mixed-Audience Deck Structure